IDEATION PHASE

Empathize & Discover

HotelPro – Hotel Room Booking and Management System

Date	12-10-2026
Team ID	SWUID2026402745
Project Name	HotelPro – Hotel Room Booking and Management System
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

Understand the needs, frustrations and behaviours of travellers and hotel guests (customers) who want to search for rooms, book, pay and manage their stay quickly through a platform like HotelPro.

Persona 1 – Customer (Traveller / Hotel Guest)

GOAL

- Find a suitable hotel room for my dates, book it without the risk of double booking, pay securely online and receive a clear confirmation.

What do they need to DO?

- Register or log in securely to my account
- Search rooms by city, check-in and check-out dates and number of guests
- Filter and sort results by price, room type, amenities and rating
- View room details (price per night, capacity, amenities) and book an available room
- Pay online through the payment gateway and receive a booking confirmation and receipt
- View my bookings, and cancel or change dates if my plans change

What do they HEAR?

- Friends and online ratings say which hotels are worth staying at
- Good rooms get booked fast during holidays and peak season
- Other travellers complain about last-minute charges and slow refunds
- Hotels advertise room types and amenities such as WiFi, parking and pool
- Reception asks for my booking ID when I arrive

What do they SAY?

- “Show me only the rooms that are really available for my dates.”
- “Don't confirm my booking until my payment goes through.”
- “Tell me the total price, including taxes, before I pay.”
- “If my plans change, I want to cancel and know about my refund.”

What do they THINK and FEEL?

PAINS

- A room shown as available but already booked; fear of double booking
- Total price changing with taxes at the last step
- Payment failing or booking not confirmed after paying
- Unclear cancellation policy and refund status
- Comparing several websites and losing track of booking details

GAINS

- Only available rooms shown for the selected dates, re-checked at confirmation
- Booking summary with the total calculated per night including taxes
- Booking confirmed only after successful payment, with a receipt
- All bookings in one place with cancel and modify options
- Secure JWT login; card details are never stored on the platform

What do they DO?

- Searches hotels and rooms in a city for specific dates and guests
- Compares price, room type, capacity and amenities across options
- Enters guest details and books the selected room
- Pays by card, UPI or net banking and checks the booking status in My Bookings
- Shows the booking ID at the front desk on arrival, and cancels or rebooks if plans change

Persona 2 – Hotel Staff / Administrator

Understand the needs of the people who run the hotel and manage the platform behind the scenes: receptionists who handle guests and administrators who manage hotels, rooms, users and reports.

GOAL

- Keep room information accurate, serve arriving and departing guests quickly, and track bookings, payments and occupancy from one system.

What do they need to DO?

- Add and update hotels, rooms, room types, prices and room status (available, occupied, maintenance, inactive)
- Record and search guest details, including ID proof, and link them to bookings
- Check guests in and out and update the room status
- View and filter all bookings by status, date or guest
- Verify payment status and record offline (counter) payments
- Monitor the dashboard and manage user accounts and roles (administrator)

What do they HEAR?

- Guests complain when a booked room is not ready or is double booked
- Owners ask for occupancy and revenue summaries
- Front-desk colleagues say paper registers are slow at busy check-in times
- Guests ask about payment and refund status

What do they SAY?

- "I need to see which rooms are available, occupied or under maintenance."
- "Don't let a room with upcoming bookings be deleted."
- "Let me find a guest's booking in seconds when they arrive."
- "Show me bookings, cancellations and revenue at a glance."

What do they THINK and FEEL?

PAINS

- Double booking and wrong room status
- Paper registers and scattered guest records
- Manually tracking payments and cancellations
- Risk of unauthorised access to guest data
- Time-consuming report preparation

GAINS

- Room status updated on check-in and check-out
- Rooms with active bookings protected from deletion
- Central guest records linked to bookings
- Role-based access for customer, staff and admin using JWT
- Dashboard showing bookings, occupancy, available rooms and revenue

What do they DO?

- Manages hotels, rooms, prices and room status
- Searches bookings and guest records on arrival
- Performs check-in and check-out and records the actual times
- Checks payments and recorded transactions
- Reviews dashboard statistics and manages users and roles

Reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas